



*The crew drove the
sharpened branch into the
Cyclops' eye.*

“AHHH!” Polyphemus awoke at the sudden pain. Blinded, he searched for Odysseus’s men with his hands, but they were hiding. Polyphemus then began to shout for help from the other Cyclopes who lived nearby. “Nobody has blinded me!” he yelled over and over, using the name Odysseus had given him. The other Cyclopes didn’t understand and thought Polyphemus had gone crazy, so they ignored his cries.

When morning came, Polyphemus had to let his sheep out to graze, but he did not want to free the men. He opened the mouth of his cave only a crack, and one by one felt the fluffy backs of his sheep as they left. Crafty Odysseus ordered each of his men to hang onto the belly of a sheep so they would not be felt by the Cyclops, and soon they were free. They ran back to their ship and set sail across the sea.



Odysseus’s men clung onto the bellies of the sheep.